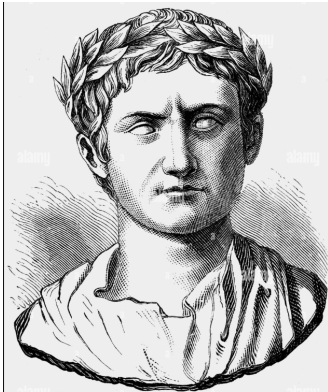


Res Gestae Divi Augusti

Author: Augustus Imperator



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Latin

Sectio 1

Summa pecuniae quam dedit vel in aerarium vel Plebei Romanae vel dimissis militibus: denarium sexiens milliens.

Sectio 2

Opera fecit nova aedem Martis, Iovis Tonantis et Feretri, Apollinis, divi Iuli, Quirini, Minervae, Iunonis Reginae, Iovis Libertatis, Larum, deum Penatium, Iuventatis, Matris Magnae, Lupercal, pulvinar ad circum, curiam cum Chalcidico, forum Augustum, basilicam Iuliam, theatrum Marcelli, porticum Octaviam, nemus trans Tiberim Caesarum.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 1 — English

Translation: The amount of money that he gave to the treasury or to the Roman plebs or to discharged soldiers was 2,400,000,000 sesterces.

Vocabulary: - imperator (nom sg m, 2nd declension): “commander”
 - senatus (nom sg m, 4th declension): “senate” - populus (nom sg m, 2nd declension): “people”

Grammar: - Ablative absolute and participial constructions are key.

History: - Augustus frames actions as restoration and peace after civil conflict.

Sectio 2 — English

Translation: His new buildings were : the temples of Mars, of Jupiter the Thunderer and Feretrius, of Apollo, of the divine Julius, of Quirinus, of Minerva, of Queen Juno, of Jupiter Libertas, of the Lares, of the Di Penates, of Youth, of the Great Mother, the Lupercal, the shrine at the Circus, the Senate House with the Chalcidicum, the Forum Augustum, the Basilica Julia, the theatre of Marcellus, the Octavian portico, the grove of the Caesars beyond the Tiber.

Vocabulary: - cum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “when”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal)

History: - Senate and people language provides constitutional legitimization (SPQR).

Latin

Sectio 3

Refecit Capitolium sacrasque aedes numero octoginta duas, theatrum Pompei, aquarum rivos, viam Flaminiam.

Sectio 4

Impensa praestita in spectacula scaenica et munera gladiatorum atque athletas et venationes et naumachiam et donata pecunia colonis, municipiis, oppidis terrae motu incendioque consumptis aut viritim amicis senatoribusque quorum census explevit innumerabilis.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 3 — English

Translation: He restored the Capitol and sacred buildings to the number of eighty-two, the theatre of Pompey, the aqueducts and the Via Flaminia.

Vocabulary: - imperator (nom sg m, 2nd declension): “commander”
 - senatus (nom sg m, 4th declension): “senate” - populus (nom sg m, 2nd declension): “people”

Grammar: - Ablative absolute and participial constructions are key.

History: - Tonal emphasis on pietas and military success is central propaganda.

Sectio 4 — English

Translation: The expenditure that he devoted to dramatic shows, to gladiatorial exhibitions and athletes and hunts and the sea battle, and the money granted to colonies, municipia, towns destroyed by earthquake and fire or to individual friends and senators whose property qualification he made up, was beyond counting.

Vocabulary: - impensa (nom sg f / nom pl n): “expense”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Religious office-count and triumphs express auctoritas in inscription tradition.

Latin

Sectio 5

Dictaturam et apsentis et praesentis mihi delatam et a populo et a senatu, M. Marcello et L. Arruntio consulibus non accepi. Non recusavi in summa frumenti penuria curationem annonae, quam ita administravi, ut intra paucos dies metu et periculo praesentis populum universum liberarem impensa et cura mea. Consulatum quoque tum annum et perpetuum mihi delatum non recepi.

Sectio 6

Consulibus M. Vinicio et Q. Lucretio et postea P. Lentulo et Cn. Lentulo et tertium Paullo Fabio Maximo et Q. Tuberone senatu populoque Romano consentientibus ut curator legum et morum summa potestate solus crearer, nullum magistratum contra morem maiorum delatum recepi. Quae tum per me geri senatus voluit, per tribuniciam potestatem perfeci, cuius potestatis conlegam et ipse ultro quinquens a senatu depoposci et accepi.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 5 — English

Translation: The dictatorship was offered to me by both senate and people in my absence and when I was at Rome in the consulship of Marcus Marcellus and Lucius Arruntius [22 BC], but I refused it. 2 I did not decline in the great dearth of corn to undertake the charge of the corn-supply, which I so administered that within a few days I delivered the whole city from apprehension and immediate danger at my own cost and by my own efforts. 3 At that time the consulship was also offered to me, to be held each year for the rest of my life, and I refused it.

Vocabulary: - consulibus (nom sg m (2nd declension)): “consuls” - impensa (nom sg f / nom pl n): “expense” - consulatum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “consulate”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result) - a/ab + ablative (agent, dative auctoris)

History: - Augustus frames actions as restoration and peace after civil conflict.

Sectio 6 — English

Translation: In the consulship of Marcus Vinicius and Quintus Lucretius [19 BC] and afterwards in that of Publius and Gnaeus Lentulus [18 BC], and thirdly in that of Paullus Fabius Maximus and Quintus Tubero [11 BC], the senate and people of Rome agreed that I should be appointed supervisor of laws and morals without a colleague and with supreme power, but I would not accept any office inconsistent with the custom of our ancestors. 2 The measures that the senate then desired me to take I carried out in virtue of my tribunician power. On five occasions, of my own initiative, I asked for and received from the senate a colleague in that power.

Vocabulary: - consulibus (nom sg m (2nd declension)): “consuls” - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Senate and people language provides constitutional legitimization (SPQR).

Latin

Sectio 7

Triumvirum rei publicae constituendae fui per continuos annos decem. Princeps senatus fui usque ad eum diem quo scripseram haec per annos quadraginta. Pontifex maximus, augur, XV virum sacris faciundis, VII virum epulorum, frater arvalis, sodalis Titius, fetialis fui.

Sectio 8

Patriciorum numerum auxi consul quintum iussu populi et senatus. Senatum ter legi, et in consulatu sexto censum populi conlega M. Agrippa egi. Lustrum post annum alterum et quadragensimum feci, quo lustrum civium Romanorum censa sunt capita quadragiens centum millia et sexaginta tria millia. Tum iterum consulari cum imperio lustrum solus feci C. Censorino et C. Asinio cos., quo lustrum censa sunt civium Romanorum capita quadragiens centum millia et ducenta triginta tria millia. Et tertium consulari cum imperio lustrum conlega Tib. Caesare filio meo feci Sex. Pompeio et Sex. Appuleio cos., quo lustrum censa sunt civium Romanorum capitum quadragiens centum millia et nongenta triginta et septem millia. Legibus novis me auctore latis multa exempla maiorum exolescentia iam ex nostro saeculo reduxi et ipse multarum rerum exempla imitanda posteris tradidi.

Translation & Notes

Section 7 — English

Translation: I was triumvir for the organization of the republic for ten consecutive years. 2 Up to the day of writing I have been princeps senatus for forty years. 3 I am pontifex maximus, augur, quindecimvir sacrisfaciundis, septemvir epulonum, frater arvalis, sodalis Titius, fetialis.

Vocabulary: - annos (): “years” - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate”

Grammar: - Ablative absolute and participial constructions are key.

History: - Tonal emphasis on pietas and military success is central propaganda.

Section 8 — English

Translation: In my fifth consulship [29 BC] I increased the number of patricians on the instructions of the people and the senate. 2 I revised the roll of the senate three times. In my sixth consulship with Marcus Agrippa as colleague [28 BC], I carried out a census of the people, and I performed a lustrum after a lapse of forty-two years ; at that lustrum 4,063,000 Roman citizens were registered. 3 Then a second time I performed a lustrum with consular imperium and without a colleague, in the consulship of Gaius Censorinus and Gaius Asinius [8 BC] ; at that lustrum 4,233,000 citizens were registered. 4 Thirdly I performed a lustrum with consular imperium, with Tiberius Caesar, my son, as colleague, in the consulship of Sextus Pompeius and Sextus Appuleius [AD 14] ; at that lustrum 4,957,000 citizens were registered. 5 By new laws passed on my proposal I brought back into use many exemplary practices of our ancestors which were disappearing in our time, and in many ways I myself transmitted exemplary practices to posterity for their imitation.

Vocabulary: - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate” - romanorum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “of the Romans” - cum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “when”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal)

History: - Religious office-count and triumphs express auctoritas in inscription tradition.

Latin

Sectio 9

Vota pro valetudine mea suscipi per consules et sacerdotes quinto quoque anno senatus decrevit. Ex iis votis saepe fecerunt vivo me ludos aliquotiens sacerdotum quattuor amplissima collegia, aliquotiens consules. Privatim etiam et municipatim universi cives unanimiter continenter apud omnia pulvinaria pro valetudine mea supplicaverunt.

Sectio 10

Nomen meum senatus consulto inclusum est in saliare carmen, et sacrosanctus in perpetuum ut essem et, quoad viverem, tribunicia potestas mihi esset, per legem sanctum est. Pontifex maximus ne fierem in vivi conlegae mei locum, populo id sacerdotium deferente mihi quod pater meus habuerat, recusavi. Quod sacerdotium aliquod post annos, eo mortuo qui civilis motus occasione occupaverat, cuncta ex Italia ad comitia mea confluyente multitudine, quanta Romae nunquam fertur ante id tempus fuisse, recepi, P. Sulpicio C. Valgio consulibus.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 9 — English

Translation: The senate decreed that vows should be undertaken every fifth year by the consuls and priests for my health. In fulfillment of these vows games have frequently been celebrated in my lifetime, sometimes by the four most distinguished colleges of priests, sometimes by the consuls. 2 Moreover, all the citizens, individually and on behalf of their towns, have unanimously and continuously offered prayers at all the pulvinaria for my health.

Vocabulary: - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate”

Grammar: - Ablative absolute and participial constructions are key.

History: - Augustus frames actions as restoration and peace after civil conflict.

Sectio 10 — English

Translation: My name was inserted in the hymn of the Salii by a decree of the senate, and it was enacted by law that my person should be inviolable for ever and that I should hold the tribunician power for the duration of my life. 2 I declined to be made pontifex maximus in the place of my colleague who was still alive, when the people offered me this priesthood which my father had held. Some years later, after the death of the man who had taken the opportunity of civil disturbance to seize it for himself, I received this priesthood, in the consulship of Publius Sulpicius and Gaius Valgius [12 BC], and such a concourse poured in from the whole of Italy to my election as has never been recorded at Rome before that time.

Vocabulary: - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate” - annos (): “years” - qui (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “who” - consulibus (nom sg m (2nd declension)): “consuls”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal) - ut clause (purpose/result) - a/ab + ablative (agent, dative auctoris)

History: - Senate and people language provides constitutional legitimization (SPQR).

Latin

Sectio 11

Aram Fortunae Reducis ante aedes Honoris et Virtutis ad portam Capenam pro reditu meo senatus consecravit, in qua pontifices et virgines Vestales anniversarium sacrificium facere iussit eo die quo, consulibus Q. Lucretio et M. Vinicio, in urbem ex Syria redieram, et diem Augustalia ex cognomine nostro appellavit.

Sectio 12

Ex senatus auctoritate pars praetorum et tribunorum plebi cum consule Q. Lucretio et principibus viris obviam mihi missa est in Campaniam, qui honos ad hoc tempus nemini praeter me est decretus. Cum ex Hispania Galliaque, rebus in iis provinciis prospere gestis, Romam redi, Ti. Nerone P. Quintilio consulibus, aram Pacis Augustae senatus pro reditu meo consecrandam censuit ad campum Martium, in qua magistratus et sacerdotes virginesque Vestales anniversarium sacrificium facere iussit.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 11 — English

Translation: The senate consecrated the altar of Fortuna Redux before the temples of Honour and Virtue at the Porta Capena in honour of my return, and it ordered that the pontifices and Vestal Virgins should make an annual sacrifice there on the anniversary of my return to the city from Syria in the consulship of Quintus Lucretius and Marcus Vinicius [12 October 19 BC], and it named the day the Augustalia from my cognomen.

Vocabulary: - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate” - consulibus (nom sg m (2nd declension)): “consuls”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Tonal emphasis on pietas and military success is central propaganda.

Sectio 12 — English

Translation: In accordance with the will of the senate some of the praetors and tribunes of the plebs with the consul Quintus Lucretius and the leading men were sent to Campania to meet me, an honor that up to the present day has been decreed to no one besides myself. 2 On my return from Spain and Gaul in the consulship of Tiberius Nero and Publius Quintilius [13 BC] after successfully arranging affairs in those provinces, the senate resolved that an altar of the Augustan Peace should be consecrated next to the Campus Martius in honor of my return, and ordered that the magistrates and priests and Vestal virgins should perform an annual sacrifice there.

Vocabulary: - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate” - cum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “when” - qui (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “who” - consulibus (nom sg m (2nd declension)): “consuls”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal)

History: - Religious office-count and triumphs express auctoritas in inscription tradition.

Latin

Sectio 13

Ianum Quinnum, quem claussum esse maiores nostri voluerunt cum per totum imperium populi Romani terra marique esset parta victoriis pax, cum priusquam nascerer, a condita urbe bis omnino clausum fuisse prodatur memoriae, ter me principe senatus claudendum esse censuit.

Sectio 14

Filios meos, quos iuvenes mihi eripuit fortuna, Gaium et Lucium Caesares honoris mei causa senatus populusque Romanus annum quintum et decimum agentis consules designavit, ut eum magistratum inirent post quinquennium, et ex eo die quo deducti sunt in forum ut interessent consiliis publicis decrevit senatus. Equites autem Romani universi principem iuventutis utrumque eorum parmis et hastis argenteis donatum appellaverunt.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 13 — English

Translation: It was the will of our ancestors that the gateway of Janus Quirinus should be shut when victories had secured peace by land and sea throughout the whole empire of the Roman people ; from the foundation of the city down to my birth, tradition records that it was shut only twice, but while I was the leading citizen the senate resolved that it should be shut on three occasions.

Vocabulary: - cum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “when” - pax (): “peace” - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal)

History: - Augustus frames actions as restoration and peace after civil conflict.

Sectio 14 — English

Translation: My sons, Gaius and Lucius Caesar, of whom Fortune bereaved me in their youth, were for my honor designated as consuls by the senate and people of Rome when they were fourteen, with the provision that they should enter on that magistracy after the lapse of five years. And the senate decreed that from the day when they were led into the forum they should take part in the councils of state. 2 Furthermore each of them was presented with silver shields and spears by the whole body of equites Romani and hailed as princeps iuventutis.

Vocabulary: - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Senate and people language provides constitutional legitimization (SPQR).

Latin

Sectio 15

Plebei Romanae viritim HS treceos numeravi ex testamento patris mei et nomine meo HS quadringenos ex bellorum manibiis consul quintum dedi, iterum autem in consulatu decimo ex patrimonio meo HS quadringenos congiari viritim pernumeravi, et consul undecimum duodecim frumentationes frumento privatim coempto emensus sum, et tribunicia potestate duodecimum quadringenos nummos tertium viritim dedi. Quae mea congiaria pervenerunt ad hominum millia numquam minus quinquaginta et ducenta. Tribuniciae potestatis duodevicensimum, consul XII, trecentis et viginti millibus plebis urbanae sexagenos denarios viritim dedi. Et colonis militum meorum consul quintum ex manibiis viritim millia nummum singula dedi; acceperunt id triumphale congiarium in colonis hominum circiter centum et viginti millia. Consul tertium decimum sexagenos denarios plebei quae tum frumentum publicum accipiebat dedi; ea millia hominum paullo plura quam ducenta fuerunt.

Sectio 16

Pecuniam pro agris quos in consulatu meo quarto et postea consulibus M. Crasso et Cn. Lentulo Augure adsignavi militibus solvi municipis; ea summa sestertium circiter sexsiens milliens fuit quam pro Italicis praedis numeravi, et circiter bis milliens et sescentiens quod pro agris provincialibus solvi. Id primus et solus omnium qui deduxerunt colonias militum in Italia aut in provinciis ad memoriam aetatis meae feci. Et postea, Ti. Nerone et Cn. Pisone consulibus itemque C. Antistio et D. Laelio cos. et C. Calvisio et L. Pasiens consulibus et L. Lentulo et M. Messalla consulibus et L. Camnio et Q. Fabricio cos., militibus quos emeriteis stipendis in sua municipia deduxi praemia numerato persolvi, quam in rem sestertium quater milliens circiter impendi.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 15 — English

Translation: To each member of the Roman plebs I paid under my father's will 300 s esterces [44 BC], and in my own name I gave them 400 each from the booty of war in my fifth consulship [29 BC], and once again in my tenth consulship [24 BC] I paid out 400 sesterces as a largesse to each man from my own patrimony, and in my eleventh consulship [23 BC] I bought grain with my own money and distributed twelve rations apiece, and in the twelfth year of my tribunician power [11 BC] I gave every man 400 sesterces for the third time. These largesses of mine never reached fewer than 250,000 persons. 2 In the eighteenth year of my tribunician power [5 BC] and my twelfth consulship I gave 240 sesterces apiece to 320,000 members of the urban plebs. 3 In my fifth consulship [29 BC] I gave 1,000 sesterces out of booty to every one of the colonists drawn from my soldiers ; about 120,000 men in the colonies received this largesse at the time of my triumph. 4 In my thirteenth consulship [2 BC] I gave 60 denarii apiece to the plebs who were then in receipt of public grain ; they comprised a few more than 200,000 persons.

Vocabulary: - dedi (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): "I gave"

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal) - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Tonal emphasis on pietas and military success is central propaganda.

Sectio 16 — English

Translation: I paid cash to the towns for the lands that I assigned to soldiers in my fourth consulship, and later in the consulship of Marcus Crassus and Gnaeus Lentulus. The sum amounted to about 600,000,000 sesterces paid for lands in Italy, and about 260,000,000 disbursed for provincial lands. Of all those who founded military colonies in Italy or the provinces I was the first and only one to have done this in the recollection of my contemporaries. 2 Later, in the consulships of Tiberius Nero and Gnaeus Piso [7 BC], of Gaius Antistius and Decimus Laelius [6 BC], of Gaius Calvisius and Lucius Pasiemus [4 BC], of Lucius Lentulus and Marcus Messalla [3 BC], and of Lucius Caninius and

Quintus Fabricius [2 BC], I paid monetary rewards to soldiers whom I settled in their home towns after completion of their service, and on this account I expended about 400,000,000 sesterces.

Vocabulary: - consulibus (nom sg m (2nd declension)): “consuls” - qui (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “who”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Religious office-count and triumphs express auctoritas in inscription tradition.

Latin**Sectio 17**

Quater pecunia mea iuvi aerarium, ita ut sestertium milliens et quingentiens ad eos qui praerant aerario detulerim. Et M. Lepido et L. Arruntio cos. in aerarium militare, quod ex consilio meo constitutum est ex quo praemia darentur militibus qui vicena aut plura stipendia emeruissent, HS milliens et septingentiens ex patrimonio meo detuli.

Sectio 18

Ab eo anno quo Cn. et P. Lentulli consules fuerunt, cum deficerent vectigalia, tum centum milibus hominum tum pluribus multo frumentarios et nummarios tributus ex horreo et patrimonio meo edidi.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 17 — English

Translation: Four times I assisted the treasury with my own money, so that I transferred to the administrators of the treasury 150,000,000 sesterces. 2 In the consulship of Marcus Lepidus and Lucius Arruntius [AD 6], when the military treasury was founded by my advice for the purpose of paying rewards to soldiers who had served for twenty years or more, I transferred to it from my own patrimony 170,000,000 sesterces.

Vocabulary: - qui (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “who” - consilio (): “counsels”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result) - a/ab + ablative (agent, dative auctoris)

History: - Augustus frames actions as restoration and peace after civil conflict.

Sectio 18 — English

Translation: From the consulship of Gnaeus and Publius Lentulus [18 BC] onwards, whenever the taxes did not suffice, I made distributions of grain and money from my own granary and patrimony, sometimes to 100,000 persons, sometimes to many more.

Vocabulary: - cum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “when”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal) - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Senate and people language provides constitutional legitimization (SPQR).

Latin

Sectio 19

Curiam et continens ei Chalcidicum templumque Apollinis in Palatio cum porticibus, aedem divi Iuli, Lupercal, porticum ad circum Flaminium, quam sum appellari passus ex nomine eius qui priorem eodem in solo fecerat, Octaviam, pulvinar ad circum maximum, aedes in Capitolio Iovis Feretri Iovis Tonantis, aedem Quirini, aedes Minervae et Iunonis Reginae et Iovis Libertatis in Aventino, aedem Larum in summa sacra via, aedem deum Penatium in Velia, aedem Iuventatis, aedem Matris Magnae in Palatio feci.

Sectio 20

Capitolium et Pompeium theatrum utrumque opus impensa grandi refeci sine ulla inscriptione nominis mei. Rivos aquarum compluribus locis vetustate labentes refeci, et aquam quae Marcia appellatur duplicavi fonte novo in rivum eius inmisso. Forum Iulium et basilicam quae fuit inter aedem Castoris et aedem Saturni, coepta profligataque opera a patre meo, perfeci et eandem basilicam consumptam incendio, ampliato eius solo, sub titulo nominis filiorum meorum incohavi, et, si vivus non perfecissem, perfici ab heredibus meis iussi. Duo et octoginta templa deum in urbe consul sextum ex auctoritate senatus refeci nullo praetermisso quod eo tempore refici debebat. Consul septimum viam Flaminiam ab urbe Ariminum refeci pontesque omnes praeter Mulvium et Minucium.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 19 — English

Translation: I built the Senate House, and the Chalcidicum adjacent to it, the temple of Apollo on the Palatine with its porticoes, the temple of the divine Julius, the Lupercal, the portico at the Flaminian circus, which I permitted to bear the name of the portico of Octavius after the man who erected the previous portico on the same site, a pulvinar at the Circus Maximus, (2) the temples on the Capitol of Jupiter Feretrius and Jupiter the Thunderer, the temple of Quirinus, the temples of Minerva and Queen Juno and Jupiter Libertas on the Aventine, the temple of the Lares at the top of the Sacred Way, the temple of the Di Penates in the Velia, the temple of Youth, and the temple of the Great Mother on the Palatine.

Vocabulary: - cum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “when” - qui (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “who”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal)

History: - Tonal emphasis on pietas and military success is central propaganda.

Sectio 20 — English

Translation: I restored the Capitol and the theatre of Pompey, both works at great expense without inscribing my own name on either. 2 I restored the channels of the aqueducts, which in several places were falling into disrepair through age, and I brought water from a new spring into the aqueduct called Marcia, doubling the supply. 3 I completed the Forum Julium and the basilica between the temples of Castor and Saturn, works begun and almost finished by my father, and when that same basilica was destroyed by fire [AD 12], I began to rebuild it on an enlarged site, to be dedicated in the name of my sons, and in case I do not complete it in my life time, I have given orders that it should be completed by my heirs. 4 In my sixth consulship [28 BC] I restored eighty-two temples of the gods in the city on the authority of the senate, neglecting none that required restoration at that time. 5 In my seventh consulship [27 BC] I restored the Via Flaminia from the city as far as Rimini, together with all bridges except the Mulvian and the Minucian.

Vocabulary: - impensa (nom sg f / nom pl n): “expense” - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Religious office-count and triumphs express auctoritas in inscription tradition.

Latin

Sectio 21

In privato solo Martis Ultoris templum forumque Augustum ex manibiis feci. Theatrum ad aedem Apollinis in solo magna ex parte a privatis empto feci, quod sub nomine M. Marcelli generi mei esset. Dona ex manibiis in Capitolio et in aede divi Iuli et in aede Apollinis et in aede Vestae et in templo Martis Ultoris consecravi, quae mihi constiterunt HS circiter milliens. Auri coronari pondo triginta et quinque millia municipiis et colonis Italiae conferentibus ad triumphos meos quintum consul remisi, et postea, quotienscumque imperator appellatus sum, aurum coronarium non accepi decernentibus municipiis et colonis aequae benigne adque antea decreverant.

Sectio 22

Ter munus gladiatorium dedi meo nomine et quinquens filiorum meorum aut nepotum nomine, quibus muneribus depugnaverunt hominum circiter decem millia. Bis athletarum undique accitorum spectaculum populo praebui meo nomine et tertium nepotis mei nomine. Ludos feci meo nomine quater, aliorum autem magistratuum vicem ter et viciens. Pro conlegio XV virorum magister conlegii collega M. Agrippa ludos saeculares C. Furnio C. Silano cos. feci. Consul XIII ludos Martiales primus feci quos post id tempus deinceps insequentibus annis s.c. et lege fecerunt consules. Venationes bestiarum Africanarum meo nomine aut filiorum meorum et nepotum in circo aut in foro aut in amphitheatris populo dedi sexiens et viciens, quibus confecta sunt bestiarum circiter tria millia et quingentae.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 21 — English

Translation: I built the temple of Mars the Avenger and the Forum Augustum on private ground from the proceeds of booty. I built the theatre adjacent to the temple of Apollo on ground in large part bought from private owners, and provided that it should be called after Marcus Marcellus, my son-in-law. 2 From the proceeds of booty I dedicated gifts in the Capitol and in the temples of the divine Julius, of Apollo, of Vesta and of Mars the Avenger ; this cost me about 100,000,000 sesterces. 3 In my fifth consulship [28 BC] I remitted 55,000 lb. of aurum coronarium contributed by the municipia and colonies of Italy to my triumphs, and later, whenever I was acclaimed imperator, I refused the aurum coronarium which the municipia and colonies continued to vote with the same good will as before.

Vocabulary: - privato (): “private” - imperator (, 2nd declension): “commander”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal)

History: - Augustus frames actions as restoration and peace after civil conflict.

Sectio 22 — English

Translation: I gave three gladiatorial games in my own name and five in that of my sons or grandsons ; at these games some 10,000 men took part in combat. Twice in my own name and a third time in that of my grandson I presented to the people displays by athletes summoned from all parts. 2 I produced shows in my own name four times and in place of other magistrates twenty-three times. On behalf of the college of quindecimviri, as its president, with Marcus Agrippa as colleague, I produced the Secular Games in the consulship of Gaius Furnius and Gaius Silanus [17 BC]. In my thirteenth consulship [2 BC] I was the first to produce the games of Mars, which thereafter in each succeeding year have been produced by the consuls in accordance with a decree of the senate and by statute. 3 I gave beast-hunts of African beasts in my own name or in that of my sons and grandsons in the circus or forum or amphitheater on twenty-six occasions, on which about 3,500 beasts were destroyed.

Vocabulary: - dedi (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “I gave”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Senate and people language provides constitutional legitimization (SPQR).

Latin

Sectio 23

Navalis proeli spectaculum populo dedi trans Tiberim in quo loco nunc nemus est Caesarum, cavato solo in longitudinem mille et octingentos pedes, in latitudinem mille et ducenti, in quo triginta rostratae naves triremes aut biremes, plures autem minores inter se conflixerunt; quibus in classibus pugnaverunt praeter remiges millia hominum tria circiter.

Sectio 24

In templis omnium civitatum provinciae Asiae victor ornamenta reposui quae spoliatis templis is cum quo bellum gesseram privatim possederat. Statuae meae pedestres et equestres et in quadrigeis argenteae steterunt in urbe XXC circiter, quas ipse sustuli, exque ea pecunia dona aurea in aede Apollinis meo nomine et illorum qui mihi statuarum honorem habuerunt posui.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 23 — English

Translation: I produced a naval battle as a show for the people at the place across the Tiber now occupied by the grove of the Caesars, where a site 1,800 feet long and 1,200 broad was excavated. There thirty beaked triremes or biremes and still more smaller vessels were joined in battle. About 3,000 men, besides the rowers, fought in these fleets.

Vocabulary: - dedi (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “I gave”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Tonal emphasis on pietas and military success is central propaganda.

Sectio 24 — English

Translation: After my victory, I replaced in the temples of all the cities of the province of Asia the ornaments which my late adversary, after despoiling the temples, had taken into his private possession. 2 Some eighty silver statues of me, on foot, on horse and in chariots had been set up in Rome ; I myself removed them, and with the money that they realized I set golden offerings in the temple of Apollo, in my own name and in the names of those who had honored me with the statues.

Vocabulary: - cum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “when” - bellum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “war” - qui (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “who”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal)

History: - Religious office-count and triumphs express auctoritas in inscription tradition.

Latin

Sectio 25

Mare pacavi a praedonibus. Eo bello servorum qui fugerant a dominis suis et arma contra rem publicam ceperant triginta fere millia capta dominis ad supplicium sumendum tradidi. Iuravit in mea verba tota Italia sponte sua, et me belli quo vici ad Actium ducem depoposcit; iuraverunt in eadem verba provinciae Galliae, Hispaniae, Africa, Sicilia, Sardinia. Qui sub signis meis tum militaverint fuerunt senatores plures quam DCC, in iis qui vel antea vel postea consules facti sunt ad eum diem quo scripta sunt haec LXXXIII, sacerdotes circiter CLXX.

Sectio 26

Omnium provinciarum populi Romani quibus finitimae fuerunt gentes quae non parerent imperio nostro fines auxi. Gallias et Hispanias provincias, item Germaniam, qua includit Oceanus a Gadibus ad ostium Albis fluminis pacavi. Alpes a regione ea quae proxima est Hadriano mari ad Tuscum pacificavi nulli genti bello per iniuriam inlato. Classis mea per Oceanum ab ostio Rheni ad solis orientis regionem usque ad fines Cimbrorum navigavit, quo neque terra neque mari quisquam Romanus ante id tempus adit. Cimbrique et Charydes et Semnones et eiusdem tractus alii Germanorum populi per legatos amicitiam meam et populi Romani petierunt. Meo iussu et auspicio ducti sunt duo exercitus eodem fere tempore in Aethiopiam et in Arabiam quae appellatur Eudaemon, magnaeque hostium gentis utriusque copiae caesae sunt in acie et complura oppida capta. In Aethiopiam usque ad oppidum Nabata perventum est, cui proxima est Meroe; in Arabiam usque in fines Sabaeorum processit exercitus ad oppidum Mariba.

Translation & Notes

Section 25 — English

Translation: I made the sea peaceful and freed it of pirates. In that war I captured about 30,000 slaves who had escaped from their masters and taken up arms against the republic, and I handed them over to their masters for punishment. 2 The whole of Italy of its own free will swore allegiance to me and demanded me as the leader in the war in which I was victorious at Actium. The Gallic and Spanish provinces, Africa, Sicily and Sardinia swore the same oath of allegiance. 3 More than seven hundred senators served under my standards at that time, including eighty-three who previously or subsequently (down to the time of writing) were appointed consuls, and about one hundred and seventy who were appointed priests.

Vocabulary: - qui (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “who” - publicam (acc sg f (1st declension)): “the republic”

Grammar: - Ablative absolute and participial constructions are key.

History: - Augustus frames actions as restoration and peace after civil conflict.

Section 26 — English

Translation: I extended the territory of all those provinces of the Roman people on whose borders lay peoples not subject to our government. 2 I brought peace to the Gallic and Spanish provinces as well as to Germany, throughout the area bordering on the Ocean from Cadiz to the mouth of the Elbe. 3 I secured the pacification of the Alps from the district nearest the Adriatic to the Tuscan sea, yet without waging an unjust war on any people. 4 My fleet sailed through the ocean eastwards from the mouth of the Rhine to the territory of the Cimbri, a country which no Roman had visited before either by land or sea, and the Cimbri, Charydes, Semnones and other German peoples of that region sent ambassadors and sought my friendship and that of the Roman people. 5 At my command and under my auspices two armies were led almost at the same time into Ethiopia and Arabia Felix ; vast enemy forces of both peoples were cut down in battle and many towns captured. Ethiopia was penetrated as far as the town of Nabata, which

adjoins Meroe ; in Arabia the army advanced into the territory of the Sabaeans to the town of Mariba.

Vocabulary: - imperator (nom sg m, 2nd declension): “commander”
- senatus (nom sg m, 4th declension): “senate” - populus (nom sg m, 2nd declension): “people”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal) - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Senate and people language provides constitutional legitimization (SPQR).

Latin

Sectio 27

Aegyptum imperio populi Romani adieci. Armeniam maiorem interfecto rege eius Artaxe cum possem facere provinciam malui maiorum nostrorum exemplo regnum id Tigrani regis Artavasdis filio, nepoti autem Tigranis regis, per Ti. Neronem tradere, qui tum mihi privignus erat. Et eandem gentem postea desciscentem et rebellantem domitam per Gaium filium meum regi Ariobarzani regis Medorum Artabazi filio regendam tradidi, et post eius mortem filio eius Artavasdi; quo interfecto Tigranem qui erat ex regio genere Armeniorum oriundus in id regnum misi. Provincias omnis quae trans Hadrianum mare vergunt ad orientem Cyrenasque, iam ex parte magna regibus ea possidentibus, et antea Siciliam et Sardiniam occupatas bello servili recipravi.

Sectio 28

Colonias in Africa, Sicilia, Macedonia, utraque Hispania, Achaia, Asia, Syria, Gallia Narbonensi, Pisidia militum deduxi. Italia autem XXVIII colonias quae vivo me celeberrimae et frequentissimae fuerunt mea auctoritate deductas habet.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 27 — English

Translation: I added Egypt to the empire of the Roman people. 2 Greater Armenia I might have made a province after its king, Artaxes had been killed, but I preferred, following the model set by our ancestors, to hand over that kingdom to Tigranes, son of King Artavasdes and grandson of King Tigranes ; Tiberius Nero, who was then my stepson, carried this out. When the same people later rebelled and went to war, I subdued them through the agency of my son Gaius and handed them over to be ruled by King Ariobarzanes, son of Artabazus, King of the Medes, and after his death to his son Artavasdes. When he was killed, I sent Tigranes, a scion of the royal Armenian house, to that kingdom. 3 I recovered all the provinces beyond the Adriatic sea towards the east, together with Cyrene, the greater part of them being then occupied by kings. I had previously recovered Sicily and Sardinia which had been seized in the slave war.

Vocabulary: - cum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “when” - qui (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “who” - erat (): “was”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal) - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Tonal emphasis on pietas and military success is central propaganda.

Sectio 28 — English

Translation: I founded colonies of soldiers in Africa, Sicily, Macedonia, both Spanish provinces, Achaea, Asia, Syria, Gallia Narbonensis and Pisidia. 2 Italy too has twenty-eight colonies founded by my authority, which were densely populated in my lifetime.

Vocabulary: - imperator (nom sg m, 2nd declension): “commander” - senatus (nom sg m, 4th declension): “senate” - populus (nom sg m, 2nd declension): “people”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Religious office-count and triumphs express auctoritas in inscription tradition.

Latin

Sectio 29

Signa militaria complura per alios duces amissa devictis hostibus recepi ex Hispania et Gallia et a Dalmateis. Parthos trium exercitum Romanorum spolia et signa reddere mihi supplicesque amicitiam populi Romani petere coegi. Ea autem signa in penetrali quod est in templo Martis Ultoris reposui.

Sectio 30

Pannoniorum gentes, quas ante me principem populi Romani exercitus nunquam adit, devictas per Ti. Neronem, qui tum erat privignus et legatus meus, imperio populi Romani subieci, protulique fines Illyrici ad ripam fluminis Danui. Citra quod Dacorum transgressus exercitus meis auspiciis victus profligatusque est, et postea trans Danuvium ductus exercitus meus Dacorum gentes imperia populi Romani perferre coegit.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 29 — English

Translation: By victories over enemies I recovered in Spain and in Gaul, and from the Dalmatians several standards lost by other commanders. 2 I compelled the Parthians to restore to me the spoils and standards of three Roman armies and to ask as supplicants for the friendship of the Roman people. Those standards I deposited in the innermost shrine of the temple of Mars the Avenger.

Vocabulary: - exercitum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “army” - romanorum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “of the Romans”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Augustus frames actions as restoration and peace after civil conflict.

Sectio 30 — English

Translation: The Pannonian peoples, whom the army of the Roman people never approached before I was the leading citizen, were conquered through the agency of Tiberius Nero, who was then my stepson and legate ; I brought them into the empire of the Roman people, and extended the frontier of Illyricum to the banks of the Danube. 2 When an army of Dacians crossed the Danube, it was defeated and routed under my auspices, and later my army crossed the Danube and compelled the Dacian peoples to submit to the commands of the Roman people.

Vocabulary: - qui (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “who” - erat (): “was”

Grammar: - Ablative absolute and participial constructions are key.

History: - Senate and people language provides constitutional legitimization (SPQR).

Latin

Sectio 31

Ad me ex India regum legationes saepe missae sunt non visae ante id tempus apud quemquam Romanorum ducem. Nostram amicitiam appetiverunt per legatos Bastarnae Scythaeque et Sarmatarum qui sunt citra flumen Tanaim et ultra reges, Albanorumque rex et Hiberorum et Medorum.

Sectio 32

Ad me supplices confugerunt reges Parthorum Tiridates et postea Phrates regis Phratis filius, Medorum Artavasdes, Adiabenorum Artaxares, Britannorum Dumnobellaunus et Tincommius, Sugambrorum Maelo, Marcomanorum Sueborum . . . rus. Ad me rex Parthorum Phrates Orodis filius filios suos nepotesque omnes misit in Italiam non bello superatus, sed amicitiam nostram per liberorum suorum pignora petens. Plurimaeque aliae gentes expertae sunt p. R. fidem me principe quibus antea cum populo Romano nullum extiterat legationum et amicitiae commercium.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 31 — English

Translation: Embassies from kings in India were frequently sent to me never before had they been seen with any Roman commander. 2 The Bastarnae, Scythians and the kings of the Sarmatians on either side of the river Don, and the kings of the Albanians and the Iberians and the Medes sent embassies to seek our friendship.

Vocabulary: - romanorum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “of the Romans” - qui (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “who”

Grammar: - Ablative absolute and participial constructions are key.

History: - Tonal emphasis on pietas and military success is central propaganda.

Sectio 32 — English

Translation: The following kings sought refuge with me as suppliants : Tiridates, King of Parthia, and later Phraates son of King Phraates ; Artavasdes, King of the Medes ; Artaxares, King of the Adiabeni ; Dumnobellaunus and Tincommius, Kings of the Britons ; Maelo, King of the Sugambri ; ... rus, King of the Marcomanni and Suebi. 2 Phraates, son of Orodes, King of Parthia, sent all his sons and grandsons to me in Italy, not that he had been overcome in war, but because he sought our friendship by pledging his children. 3 While I was the leading citizen very many other peoples have experienced the good faith of the Roman people which had never previously exchanged embassies or had friendly relations with the Roman people.

Vocabulary: - cum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “when”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal)

History: - Religious office-count and triumphs express auctoritas in inscription tradition.

Latin

Sectio 33

A me gentes Parthorum et Medorum per legatos principes earum gentium reges petitos acceperunt: Parthi Vononem, regis Phratis filium, regis Orodís nepotem, Medi Ariobarzanem, regis Artavazdis filium, regis Ariobarzanis nepotem.

Sectio 34

In consulatu sexto et septimo, postquam bella civilia exstinxeram, per consensum universorum potitus rerum omnium, rem publicam ex mea potestate in senatus populique Romani arbitrium transtuli. Quo pro merito meo senatus consulto Augustus appellatus sum et laureis postes aedium mearum vestiti publice coronaque civica super ianuam meam fixa est et clupeus aureus in curia Iulia positus, quem mihi senatum populumque Romanum dare virtutis clementiaeque et iustitiae et pietatis caussa testatum est per eius clupeí inscriptionem. Post id tempus auctoritate omnibus praestiti, potestatis autem nihilo amplius habui quam ceteri qui mihi quoque in magistratu conlegae fuerunt.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 33 — English

Translation: The Parthian and Median peoples sent to me ambassadors of their nobility who sought and received kings from me, for the Parthians Vonones, son of King Phraates, grandson of King Orodes, and for the Medes, Ariobarzanes, son of King Artavasdes, grandson of King Ariobarzanes.

Vocabulary: - imperator (nom sg m, 2nd declension): “commander”
 - senatus (nom sg m, 4th declension): “senate” - populus (nom sg m, 2nd declension): “people”

Grammar: - a/ab + ablative (agent, dative auctoris)

History: - Augustus frames actions as restoration and peace after civil conflict.

Sectio 34 — English

Translation: In my sixth and seventh consulships [28-27 BC], after I had extinguished civil wars, and at a time when with universal consent I was in complete control of affairs, I transferred the republic from my power to the dominion of the senate and people of Rome. 2 For this service of mine I was named Augustus by decree of the senate, and the door-posts of my house were publicly wreathed with bay leaves and a civic crown was fixed over my door and a golden shield was set in the Curia Julia, which, as attested by the inscription thereon, was given me by the senate and people of Rome on account of my courage, clemency, justice and piety. 3 After this time I excelled all in influence [auctoritas], although I possessed no more official power [potestas] than others who were my colleagues in the several magistracies.

Vocabulary: - publicam (acc sg f (1st declension)): “the republic” - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate” - augustus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 2nd declension): “Augustus” - qui (gen sg / nom pl m (2nd declension)): “who”

Grammar: - ut clause (purpose/result)

History: - Senate and people language provides constitutional legitimization (SPQR).

Latin**Sectio 35**

Tertium decimum consulatum cum gerebam, senatus et equester ordo populusque Romanus universus appellavit me patrem patriae, idque in vestibulo aedium mearum inscribendum et in curia Iulia et in foro Aug. sub quadrigis quae mihi ex s.c. positae sunt censuit. Cum scripsi haec annum agebam septuagensimum sextum.

Translation & Notes

Sectio 35 — English

Translation: In my thirteenth consulship [2 BC] the senate, the equestrian order and the whole people of Rome gave me the title of Father of my Country, and resolved that this should be inscribed in the porch of my house and in the Curia Julia and in the Forum Augustum below the chariot which had been set there in my honor by decree of the senate.
2 At the time of writing I am in my seventy-sixth year. Appendix

Vocabulary: - consulatum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “consulate”
- cum (acc sg n (2nd declension)): “when” - senatus (nom sg m (2nd declension), 4th declension): “senate”

Grammar: - cum + clause (temporal/causal)

History: - Tonal emphasis on pietas and military success is central propaganda.

Source: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Res_Gestae_Divi_Augusti

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Res Gestae Divi Augusti (contemporaneous and authorised Ancient Greek translation: Σ ; Eng. The Deeds of the Divine Augustus) is a monumental inscription composed by the first Roman emperor, Augustus, giving a first-person record of his life and accomplishments. The Res Gestae is especially significant because it gives an insight into the image Augustus presented to the Roman people. Various portions of the Res Gestae have been found in modern Turkey. The inscription itself is a monument to the establishment of the Julio-Claudian dynasty that was to follow Augustus.

The text consists of a short introduction, 35 body paragraphs and a posthumous addendum. The paragraphs are conventionally grouped into four sections: political career, public benefactions, military accomplishments and a political statement.

The text was completed one month before Augustus' death (19 August AD 14), although much of the content was written earlier and revised. Augustus left the text with his will, instructing the Senate to set up the inscriptions. The original, engraved on a pair of bronze pillars and placed before Augustus' mausoleum, has not survived; several stone copies and Greek translations survive (notably the Monumentum Ancyranum at Ancyra), which are the basis for modern editions.

- Sections 2–14: political career and offices held, including offices refused and privileges declined.
- Sections 15–24: public benefactions — monetary gifts, land distributions, grain doles, public works, and games, emphasising that these were paid from Augustus' private resources.
- Sections 25–33: military achievements and the establishment of client kingdoms and alliances.
- Sections 34–35: statement of Roman approval and the granting of honorifics; appendix lists buildings and sums expended.

The text has been studied and translated many times; copies and inscriptions circulated across the Roman world. Modern scholarship treats the Res Gestae as a crafted self-portrait and propaganda piece, useful when read alongside other sources and archaeological evidence.

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for the live article.*

This booklet presents the *Res Gestae Divi Augusti* in a compact study format: authentic Latin text on the left-hand A5 pages and reliable English translations, vocabulary, grammar notes, and brief historical context on facing pages. The *Res Gestae* is Augustus' own account of his life, offices, benefactions, and military achievements — a carefully constructed public self-portrait composed shortly before his death in AD 14.

This edition is a working prototype intended for personal study use. It preserves the Latin inscriptions' structure (35 numbered sections) and pairs each Latin passage with: - an English rendering for comprehension, - a short vocabulary list highlighting key words and forms, - a concise grammar note on constructions that recur in the passage, - a brief historical note situating the passage.

Format and purpose: - A5 smallpages, two sections per page — Latin left, translation and notes right. - Designed for print-imposed A4 duplex output; cover and impressum included. - Focused on readability for learners of Latin and instructors: fast cross-reference, clear typographic separation of original and commentary, and pragmatic glosses rather than extended commentary.

Credits & sources: Primary Latin text sourced from public-domain inscriptions and critical editions. English renderings and contextual material are compiled from scholarly translations and public sources (see `data/english.txt` and `data/res_gestae_wikipedia.md`).

This booklet is experimental: corrections, improved translations, and expanded notes will follow. If you use this booklet in teaching or research, please report typos, mistranslations, or layout issues to the maintainer so they can be addressed in future editions.

Booklet designed and prepared by Gilles Demaneuf

